

A M E R I C A N
HISTORICAL AND LITERARY CURIOSITIES;

CONSISTING OF

FAC-SIMILES OF ORIGINAL DOCUMENTS RELATING TO THE EVENTS
OF THE REVOLUTION,
&c. &c.

WITH A VARIETY OF

RELIQUES, ANTIQUITIES,

AND

MODERN AUTOGRAPHS.

COLLECTED AND EDITED

BY

JOHN JAY SMITH,
MEMBER OF THE HISTORICAL SOCIETY OF PENNSYLVANIA,

AND

JOHN F. WATSON,
ANNALIST OF PHILADELPHIA AND NEW YORK.

ASSISTED BY AN ASSOCIATION OF AMERICAN ANTIQUARIANS.

SIXTH EDITION; WITH IMPROVEMENTS AND ADDITIONS.

NEW YORK:
G. P. PUTNAM.
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AMERICAN HISTORICAL
AND
LITERARY CURIOSITIES

By John Jay Smith and John F. Watson

Part 3.

P R E F A C E

TO THE FIFTH EDITION.

FIRST SERIES.

THE past has a charm for Americans, as well as for the inhabitants of countries whose history extends far into the shadowy and unknown; *our* early and romantic past has the merit of being known and truly related; everything which adds to these truths is sought for with avidity by the curious and intelligent inquirer. We have now many autograph collectors, who may be viewed in the light of preservers of documents which would otherwise perish or be dispersed; to few, comparatively, are their treasures revealed. It was suggested, therefore, that a few of the most rare and curious "Historical and Literary Curiosities" in the possession of individuals, should be grouped for the amusement and instruction of the present and of future generations, who may well know from printed accounts *what* things were done, but who can also thus learn *how* they were done.

Nearly all the articles in the present collection have been taken by competent artists from the originals of which they purport to be fac-similes. Considerable labor and trouble have been expended in collecting together the varied materials here presented; but it has been with the Editors a "labor of love," rewarded by the pleasure of the pursuit.

The work having been received with extraordinary favor by the public, and a fifth edition being called for, some additions and alterations have been made, which will create increased interest in the volume.

J. JAY SMITH,
JOHN F. WATSON.

* * Fully to understand the work, it is necessary, in turning over the pages, to have constant reference to the Table of Contents, where will be found many explanations for which space could not be found on the plates.

NOTE TO THE SIXTH EDITION.

Notwithstanding the announcement in the second series of this work that the first would not be reprinted, the public has demanded a sixth edition, which has been entirely redrawn, and many highly interesting additions have been made.

PHILADELPHIA, October, 1860.

Part Three

Plate 15.—Bust of William Penn, from an Ivory cutting, by Sylvanus Bevan, a cotemporary of William Penn; now in the possession of Paul Bevan, near London; the original from which the portraits of Penn are taken. Letter of William Penn. In the possession of Benjamin H. Coates, M. D.

Plate 16. Letter from George Whitfield, speaking of his proposed voyage to America. In the possession of J. Jay Smith.

Plate 17.—Letter from Kosciusko to Charles Pettit, Esq. In the possession of Professor Henry Read.

Plates 18 and 19.—Letter from Robert Fulton, and a picture of his first Steamboat.

Plate 20.—Autograph signatures of the Presidents of the old Continental Congress, 1778; of Presidents of the U. States; of Pizarro, Rip Van Dam, Myles Standish; also of the Salem Witch Judges, the Sheriff who hung them, &c. In possession of F. J. Etting, Esq., J. Wingate Thornton, Esq., and others.

Plate 21.—Challenge of Baron Steuben to General Lee, in French. See Sparks' American Biography, vol. 9, p. 32. In the possession of Henry C. Baird, Esq.
The Grand Inquest of the city and County of Philadelphia, presenting the great necessity for a Ducking Stool: 1722. In the possession of Edward D. Ingraham, Esq.

[Plate 15.](#)

[Plate 16.](#)

[Plate 17.](#)

[Plate 18.](#)

[Plate 19.](#)

[Plate 20.](#)

[Plate 21.](#)

From a small
ivory model in basso
relievo by Silvanus
Bevan a contempora-
ry of William Penn.



in the possession of
Paul Bevan near
London. The original
from which the Por-
traits of William
Penn have been taken.

WILLIAM PENN

Whitehall 2 - 10⁶² - 1702

I do hereby declare & Promise
That I will take no advantage
of the Queens Royall approbation
of Col^d Andrew Hamilton to be
my Lieut Govern^r of Pennsylvania
& Countys annexed, in reference
to the Queens Intentions to the
Government of the said lower Countys
after expiration thereof;

Wm Penn

my Declare
Wm of L^d of
Ar. & Plant

Enlarge

My O^r. M^r. Read

London March 25
1762

Th^t I have had
an inflammation in my eye added to my
former disorders yet I must try to answer
your kind letter - By that I find you have
been in the furnace of affliction - May you
come forth like gold! We must all be tried
through much tribulation we must enter
into glory - I believe you w^d not be better
by coming hither - It is cowardly to fly
from the cross - If the Redeemer spares
me I have thoughts of taking an American Voyage
Who knows but we may meet once more on this side
Jordan? Lord Jesus help us in all things to say,
not my will but thine be done - I can as yet preach
but twice or thrice a week - But the Redeemer is
able to do more for me - I know you will pray
that He may - * * * *

Yours &c in our Common
Redeemer
Whitfield

Enlarge

Letter from Koskiosko.

Dear Sir Philadelphia 10. June Surest way, not subject to changes, and
I received your favour of this day and draw regularly percent due from
Send you my warmest thanks — this Summ I beg you was so kind
See the impossibility of having the honour to give your opinion whether upon the
for an half hour a personal conversation Bank of the United States, or upon a
with you, it you can only support a walk Provincial or other way with the many
in the room. I can't even to move from how to do it in what manner you better
one place to the other without the support in God so rely upon you as a
and help of my crutches and a servant upon your character and friend
The business upon which I would ask your ~~help~~ which you honour me
advice is of pecuniary kind. I want to with Perfect Esteem and
lay Money upon interest but in the Present my kisses regard
to all your Ladies — Humbl Servant
Koskiosko

PL. XVII.

Enlarge

Paris the 20th of September 1802

To Mr. Fulton Newport

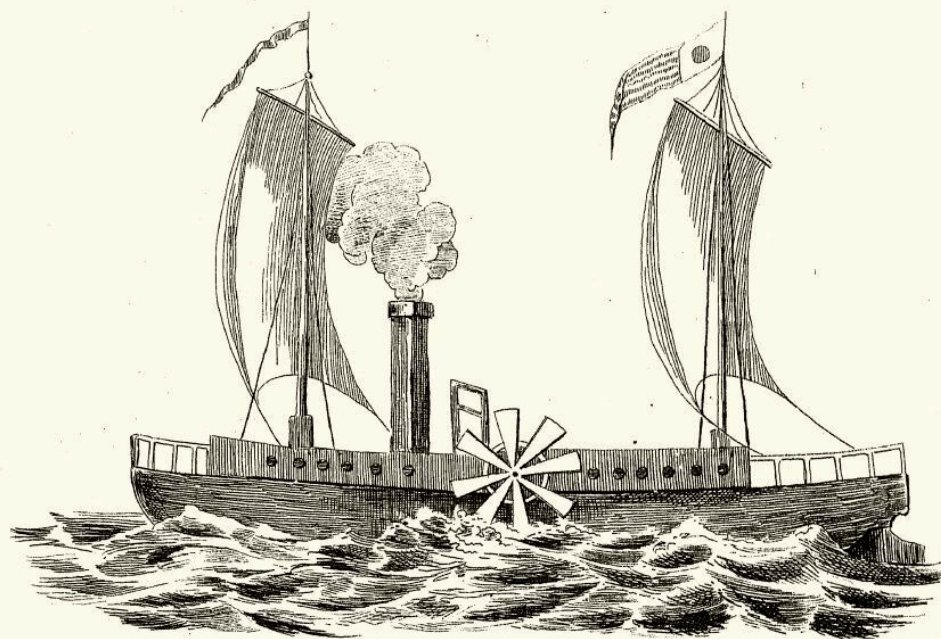
For the expense of a patent in France is 300 Livers for 3 years 800 L^{rs} for 10 years and 1500 L^{rs} for 15 years. there can be no difficulty in obtaining a patent for the mode of propelling a boat which you have shown one but if the author of the model wishes to be assured of the merits of his invention before he goes to the expense of a patent. I advise him to make a model of a boat in which he can place a clock spring which will give about 3 Revolutions he can then combine the movements, as to try oars, paddles, and the leaves which he proposes if he finds that the leaves drive the boat a greater distance in the same time than either oars or Paddles ^{then} it consequently are a better application of power - About 8 years ago the Earl of Stanhope tried an experiment on similar leaves in Greenland Dock London but without success - I have also tried experiments on similar leaves. Wheels, oars, paddles, and flyers similar to those of a smooth Jacks and found oars to be the best; The Velocity with which a boat moves, is in proportion to the sum of the surfaces of the oars paddles leaves or other machine, is to the bow of the boat presented to the water, and in proportion to the Power with which such machinery is put in motion, hence if the sum of the surfaces of the oars ^{is} equal to the sum of the surfaces of the leaves and they pass through similar curves in the same time, the effect must be the same but oars have this advantage they return through air to make a second stroke and hence create very little resistance, whereas the leaves return through water and add considerably to the resistance which

Enlarge

resistance is increased as the velocity of the boat is augmented; no kind of machinery can create power all that can be done is to apply the manual, or other power to the best advantage -

If the author of the model is fond of mechanics he will be much amused and not lose his time by trying the experiments in the manner I propose and this perhaps is the most prudent measure, before a patent is taken

I am Sir with much Respect
yours Robt Fulton



Fulton's Steamboat

Enlarge

(Autographs of the Presidents of the Old Continental Congress 1774-1778.)

<i>Samuel Randolph</i>	<i>Thos M. Keap, President</i>
<i>Henry Middleton</i>	<i>John Hanson jr</i>
<i>John Hancock President</i>	<i>Edw. Bordinist</i>
<i>Thomas Lawrence</i>	<i>Thos. Mifflin</i>
<i>President</i>	<i>Richard Henry Lee</i>
<i>John Jay</i>	<i>Nathaniel Gorham</i>
<i>Presid</i>	<i>A. S. Claiborne</i>
<i>Levin. Huntington President</i>	<i>Lucius Griffin</i>

Presidents of the United States.

<i>James Madison</i>	<i>Andrew Jackson</i>	<i>J. Q. Adams</i>
<i>James Monroe</i>	<i>John Tyler</i>	<i>James K. Polk</i>
<i>Z Taylor</i>	<i>Franklin Pierce</i>	<i>Jefferson</i>
<i>James Buchanan</i>	<i>Abraham Lincoln</i>	
<i>Franklin</i>	<i>Chas. V. Davis</i>	<i>Myles Standish</i>

Salem Witch Judges.

1683 *Barth^o Godney Smith*

1692 *John Hathorne*
Jonathan Corwin, J. of the Court

1694 *George Corwin Sheriff*
Ch. Justice Wm. -

1713 *Samuel Sewall*

Recd. Salem June 13 1738 of Mr. Phillips
English the sum of three pounds five
shillings & 4 p. in full of all acc^{ts}
\$3:5:4 *P. D. Burton*

Appointed by the Court to examine Witches
in 1692, to see if they had any preternatural
appearances on their bodies.

Enlarge

Challenge of Baron Steuben to Gen^l Lee.

Monsieur! Il m'est revenu que dans votre dessein
 Vous vous êtes permis, à mon sujet, des Reflexions indis-
 cretes. Je me suis hâte de venir à Philadelphie
 pour m'en éclaircir, et je trouve le rapporte confirme
 pas le journal de la Cour Martiale qui m'est parvenue
 depuis un heur, on y lit le paragraphe suivant.

Of all very distant Spectators etc. etc.

Si j'étais dans ma Patrie ou ma réputation est
 des long temps faite; je me ferais mis au dessus de
 vos Epigrammes et les autres meprise. Mais je suis
 ici étranger. Vous m'avez offensé. Je vous en
 demande Raïson.

Vous choisirez le Lieu le temps et les Armes
 mais comme je n'aime à être Spectateur si éloigné
 ni tardif; je vous demande de vous voir aussi près
 et aussi tôt que possible.

M. le Capit. Waltes qui vous remettra la présente
 m'informera de vos résolutions

Je suis

Monsieur

Philadelphie
 ce 2 de Dec;

Votre très humble serviteur
 Le Baron de Steuben

City Philad^a

The Grand Jurors

We Taking in Consideration the past Disorder
 of the Turbulent and ill Behavior of many
 people in this City we present the Great Necessity
 of a Ducking Stool for such people according
 to their Deserts

Signed by the Foreman for himself &
 Brethren

Thomas Gifford

Enlarge

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK AMERICAN
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From a small
ivory model in basso
relievo by Silvanus
Bevan a contempora-
ry of William Penn.



in the possession of
Paul Bevan near
London. The original
from which the Por-
traits of William
Penn have been taken.

WILLIAM PENN

Whitehall 2 - 10⁶² - 1702

I do hereby declare & Promise
That I will take no advantage
of the Queens Royall approbation
of Col^d Andrew Hamilton to be
my Lieut Govern^r of Pennsylvania
& Countys annexed, in reference
to the Queens Intentions to the
Government of the said lower Countys
after expiration thereof;

Wm Penn

my Declare
Wm of L^d of
Ar. & Plant

[back](#)

My V^r M^r. Read

London March 25
1762

Tho I have had
an inflammation in my eye added to my
former disorders yet I must try to answer
your kind letter - By that I find you have
been in the furnace of affliction - May you
come forth like gold! We must all be tried
through much tribulation we must enter
into glory - I believe you w^d not be better
by coming hither - It is cowardly to fly
from the cross - If the Redeemer spares
me I have thoughts of taking an American Voyage
Who knows but we may meet once more on this side
Jordan? Lord Jesus help us in all things to say,
not my will but thine be done - I can as yet preach
but twice or thrice a week - But the Redeemer is
able to do more for me - I know you will pray
that He may - * * * *

Yours &c in our Common
Redeemer
Whitfield

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Dear Sir Philadelphia 10. Nov. Surest way, not subject to changes, and
 I received your favour of this day and draw regularly proceunt due from
 send you my warmest thanks — this sum I beg you was to kind
 Give the impossibility of having the honour to give your opinion wether upon the
 for an half hour a personal conversation Bank of the United States, or upon a
 with you, it you can only support a walk Provincial or other way with the money
 in the room. I cannot even to move from how to do it in what maner you beten
 one place to the other without the support in God to rely upon you as a the
 and help of my butches and a servant upon your character and friend ship
 The business upon which I would ask your ~~help~~ which you a honour me
 advice is of pecuniary kind. I want to with Perfect Esteem and
 lay Money upon interest but in the Present my kisses regard you Humbl. Servant
 to all your Ladies — Koskiosko

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Paris the 20th of September 1802

To Mr. Fulvor Sheppith

For the expense of a patent in France is 300 Livers for 3 years 800 L^{rs} for 10 years and 1500 L^{rs} for 15 years. there can be no difficulty in obtaining a patent for the mode of propelling a boat which you have shown one but if the author of the model wishes to be assured of the merits of his invention before he goes to the expense of a patent. I advise him to make a model of a boat in which he can place a clock spring which will give about 3 Revolutions he can then combine the movements, as to try oars, paddles, and the leaves which he proposes if he finds that the leaves drive the boat a greater distance in the same time than either oars or Paddles ^{then} it consequently are a better application of power - About 8 years ago the Earl of Stanhope tried an experiment on similar leaves in Greenland Dock London but without success - I have also tried experiments on similar leaves. Wheels, oars, paddles, and flyers similar to those of a smooth Jacks and found oars to be the best; The Velocity with which a boat moves, is in proportion to the sum of the surfaces of the oars paddles leaves or other machine, is to the bow of the boat presented to the water, and in proportion to the Power with which such machinery is put in motion, hence if the sum of the surfaces of the oars ^{is} equal to the sum of the surfaces of the leaves and they pass through similar curves in the same time, the effect must be the same but oars have this advantage they return through air to make a second stroke and hence create very little resistance, whereas the leaves return through water and add considerably to the resistance which

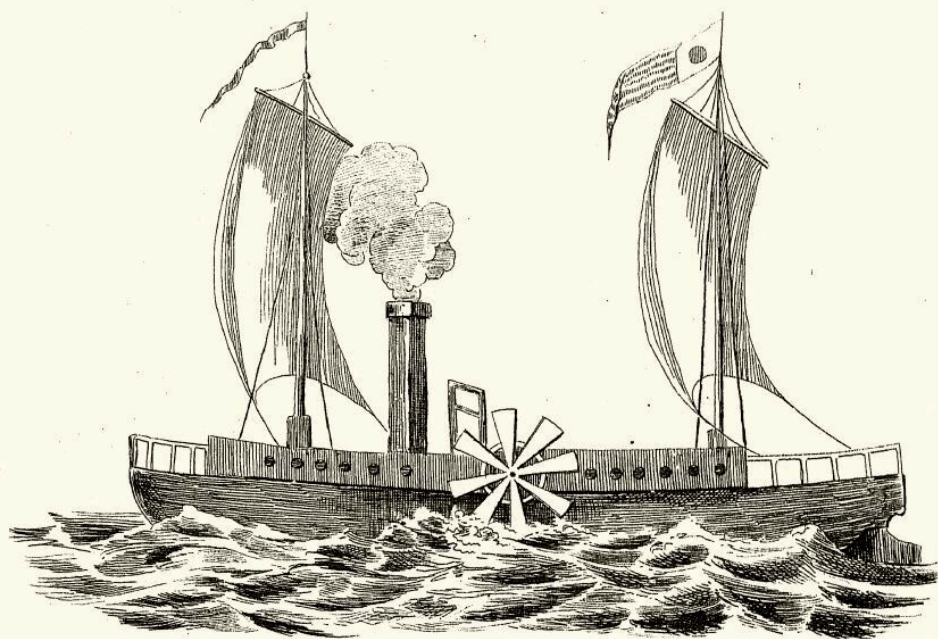
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resistance is increased as the velocity of the boat is augmented; no kind of machinery can create power all that can be done is to apply the manual, or other power to the best advantage -

If the author of the model is fond of mechanics he will be much amused and not lose his time by trying the experiments in the manner I propose and this perhaps is the most prudent measure, before a patent is taken

I am Sir with much Respect

Yours Robt Fulton



Fulton's Steamboat

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(Autographs of the Presidents of the Old Continental Congress 1774-1778.

<i>Samuel Randolph</i>	<i>Thos M. Keap, President</i>
<i>Henry Middleton</i>	<i>John Hanson jr</i>
<i>John Hancock President</i>	<i>Edw. Bordinist</i>
<i>Thomas Lawrence</i>	<i>Thos Mifflin</i>
<i>President</i>	<i>Richard Henry Lee</i>
<i>John Jay</i>	<i>Nathaniel Gorham</i>
<i>Presid</i>	<i>A. S. Claiborne</i>
<i>Leinn. Huntington President</i>	<i>Lucius Griffin</i>

Presidents of the United States.

<i>James Madison</i>	<i>Andrew Jackson</i>	<i>J. Q. Adams</i>
<i>James Monroe</i>	<i>John Tyler</i>	<i>James K. Polk</i>
<i>Z Taylor</i>	<i>Franklin Pierce</i>	<i>Jefferson</i>
<i>James Buchanan</i>	<i>Abraham Lincoln</i>	
<i>Franklin</i>	<i>Chas. V. Sumner</i>	<i>Myles Standish</i>

Salem Witch Judges.

1683 *Barth^o Godney Smith*

1692 *John Hathorne*
Jonathan Corwin, J. of the Court

1694 *George Corwin Sheriff*
Ch. Justice Wm. -

1713 *Samuel Sewall*

Recd. Salem June 13 1738 of Mr. Phillips
English the sum of three pounds five
shillings & 4 p. in full of all acc^{ts}
\$3:5:4 *P. D. Burton*

Appointed by the Court to examine Witches
in 1692, to see if they had any preternatural
appearances on their bodies.

Challenge of Baron Steuben to Gen^l Lee.

Monsieur! Il m'est revenu que dans votre dessein
 Vous vous êtes permis, à mon sujet, des Reflexions indis-
 cretes. Je me suis hâté de venir à Philadelphie
 pour m'en éclaircir, et je trouve le rapporte confirme
 pas le journal de la Cour Martiale qui m'est parvenue
 depuis un heure, on y lit le paragraphe suivant.

Of all very distant Spectators etc. etc.

Si j'étais dans ma Patrie ou ma réputation est
 des long temps faite; je me ferais mis au dessus de
 vos Epigrammes et les aurais méprisé. Mais je suis
 ici étranger. Vous m'avez offensé. Je vous en
 demande Pardon.

Vous choisirez le Lieu le temps et les Armes
 mais comme je n'aime à être Spectateur si éloigné
 ni tardif; je vous demande de vous voir aussi près
 et aussi tôt que possible.

M. le Capit. Walther qui vous remettra la présente
 m'informera de vos résolutions

Je suis

Monsieur

Philadelphie
 ce 2 de Dec;

Votre très humble serviteur
 Le Baron de Steuben

City Philad^a

The Grand Jurors

We Taking in Consideration the past Disorder
 of the Turbulent and ill Behavior of many
 people in this City we present the Great Necessity
 of a Ducking Stool for such people according
 to their Deserts

Signed by the Foreman for himself &
 Brethren

Thomas Gifford